

Microsoft 365 Collaboration Ecosystem and Service Integrations

Groups, Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive and Copilot

Microsoft 365 Groups

Outlook

Teams

SharePoint

OneDrive

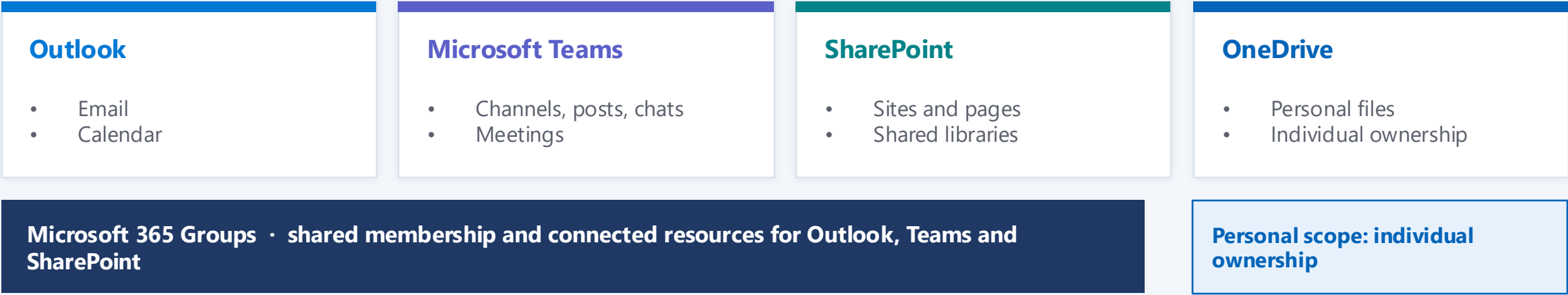
Copilot

Purpose of each service · How they differ · How they integrate · Where content is stored

Microsoft 365 collaboration overview

Different primary purposes, one shared foundation of identity, permissions and content

Microsoft 365 Copilot intelligence layer working across the information each user is authorised to access



ADDITIONAL INTEGRATED SERVICES



Read this as Microsoft 365 Groups provide the membership foundation for many shared experiences; this overview shows the layers, not yet every integration.

Microsoft 365 Groups

A shared membership and resource foundation, not an application



A Microsoft 365 Group is a shared membership and resource container that other services build on - it is not an application you open.

- One membership list reused by Outlook, Teams, SharePoint and Planner
- Every Group gets a group mailbox, a shared calendar and a SharePoint team site
- Groups can be public or private, and a Team is optional

Key distinction A Group is the membership and resource container; the applications are the experiences built on top of it.

Access <https://outlook.cloud.microsoft/groups/home>

Outlook

The email and calendar experience for personal and group communication



Outlook is the email and calendar experience for both personal and group communication.

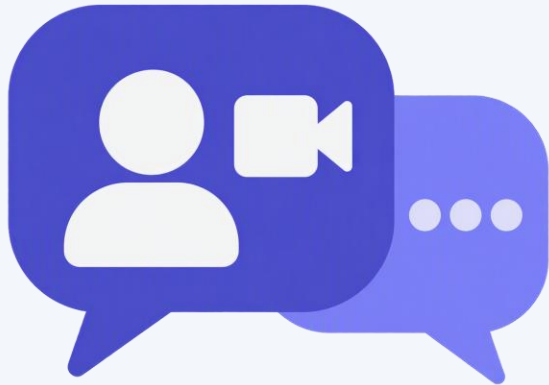
- Personal mailbox and personal calendar belong to the user
- Group mailbox and group calendar belong to the Microsoft 365 Group
- My Groups shows joined Groups; Discover Groups shows public Groups to join

Key distinction Personal mailbox and calendar belong to the user; group mailbox and group calendar belong to the Microsoft 365 Group.

Access <https://outlook.cloud.microsoft/>

Microsoft Teams

The communication and collaboration workspace



Microsoft Teams is the workspace for conversation, meetings and day-to-day collaboration.

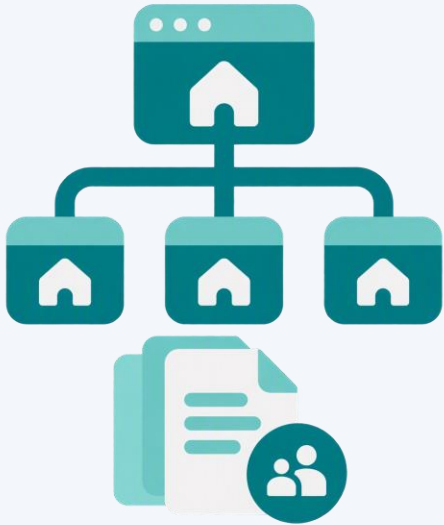
- Channels, posts, chats and online meetings in one place
- Every standard team is backed by a Microsoft 365 Group
- Channel files are stored in the connected SharePoint site

Key distinction Teams provides the interface for conversation and meetings; membership and shared files live in the Group and its SharePoint sites.

Access <https://teams.cloud.microsoft/>

SharePoint

The shared organisational content platform



SharePoint is the platform that stores and publishes shared organisational content.

- Team sites, communication sites, document libraries, pages and lists
- Every Microsoft 365 Group has a connected team site
- Only Group-connected sites inherit Group membership

Key distinction Group-connected team sites and standalone sites are both SharePoint; only the first inherits Microsoft 365 Group membership.

Access <https://www.microsoft365.com/launch/sharepoint> site address: `https://<tenant>.sharepoint.com/sites/<site-name>`

OneDrive

Personal file storage for an individual user's working files



OneDrive is personal cloud storage for an individual user's working files.

- Files are owned by the user and shared only by explicit invitation
- Built on SharePoint technology, but it is not a shared team location
- Content meant for the whole group belongs in SharePoint

OneDrive: My files

SharePoint: Our files

Access <https://www.microsoft365.com/launch/onedrive> *personal library: <https://<tenant>-my.sharepoint.com>*

Microsoft 365 Copilot



An intelligence layer working across authorised Microsoft 365 information

AUTHORISED CONTEXT COPILOT CAN USE

Outlook

Teams

SharePoint

OneDrive

Calendars

Meetings

All of this is filtered by the user's existing permissions

WHAT COPILOT DOES

- Summarises, drafts and compares authorised content
- Works across several services in one request
- Surfaces actions, decisions and follow-ups

WHAT COPILOT DOES NOT DO

- Grant access to information the user cannot already open
- Replace Outlook, Teams, SharePoint or OneDrive
- Create a separate copy of organisational content

Key distinction Where information is stored, how it is organised and who has permission all shape the context available to Copilot.

Access <https://m365.cloud.microsoft/chat>

Other Microsoft 365 products

Services that extend the collaboration ecosystem beyond the six primary components

MICROSOFT PLANNER



Task management for plans, buckets and assignments, shared with Groups and Teams.

<https://planner.cloud.microsoft/>

MICROSOFT FORMS



Surveys, quizzes and questionnaires shared through Teams, Outlook and SharePoint.

<https://forms.cloud.microsoft/>

MICROSOFT ONENOTE



Shared notebooks for collaborative notes inside Teams and SharePoint spaces.

<https://www.microsoft365.com/launch/onenote>

MICROSOFT LOOP



Collaborative workspaces whose components stay in sync across Teams and Outlook.

<https://loop.cloud.microsoft/>

MICROSOFT STREAM



Video across Microsoft 365, stored in SharePoint or OneDrive depending on ownership.

<https://www.microsoft365.com/launch/stream>

MICROSOFT VIVA ENGAGE



Communities and organisation-wide conversations that complement Outlook and Teams.

<https://engage.cloud.microsoft/>

Scope These products extend the ecosystem and appear in the final map, but they are not part of the pairwise integration analysis that follows.

Microsoft 365 Groups and Outlook



Microsoft 365 Groups

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Outlook

- Microsoft 365 Groups provide a shared identity for a team or community.
- A Microsoft 365 Group includes a group email address and a shared mailbox.
- Emails sent to the group address can be delivered to all group members.
- Members can read and participate in group conversations from Outlook.
- Groups can be Public or Private.
- Public groups can be discovered by users in the organization.
- Users can join public groups.

Microsoft 365 Groups and Calendar



Microsoft 365 Groups

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Group calendar

- Each Microsoft 365 Group includes a shared calendar.
- Group members can view events in the group calendar.
- Group members can create and manage events in the group calendar.
- Group calendar events are visible to all group members.
- Inviting a group to an event adds the event to the calendars of the group members.
- Group calendars help coordinate activities across the group.

Microsoft 365 Groups and Teams



Microsoft 365 Groups

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Microsoft Teams

- Each Microsoft Teams team is associated with a Microsoft 365 Group.
- Team membership is based on Microsoft 365 Group membership.
- Adding a member to a team adds the user to the associated Microsoft 365 Group.
- Removing a member from a team removes the user from the associated Microsoft 365 Group.
- Team owners are also owners of the associated Microsoft 365 Group.
- Microsoft 365 Groups provide the membership foundation for Teams.
- Changes to group membership are reflected in the team.

Microsoft 365 Groups and SharePoint



Microsoft 365 Groups

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SharePoint

- Each Microsoft 365 Group includes a SharePoint team site.
- Group members automatically receive access to the associated SharePoint site.
- SharePoint site permissions are based on group membership.
- Adding or removing group members updates access to the SharePoint site.
- Documents and content stored in the SharePoint site are shared with group members.
- SharePoint provides the collaborative content workspace for the group.

Outlook and Teams



Outlook

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Microsoft Teams

- Outlook and Teams share the same Microsoft 365 calendar.
- Teams meetings can be scheduled directly from Outlook.
- Teams meetings created in Outlook appear in Teams.
- Meeting invitations and updates are delivered through Outlook.
- Users can join Teams meetings directly from Outlook.
- Outlook and Teams provide a unified meeting and scheduling experience.

Outlook, SharePoint and OneDrive



Outlook

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SharePoint

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OneDrive

- Emails can include links to files stored in SharePoint and OneDrive.
- Users can share files from SharePoint and OneDrive directly from Outlook.
- File permissions can be managed when sharing links in Outlook.
- Recipients can collaborate on shared documents without email attachments.
- Updates to shared files are reflected automatically because the content remains stored in SharePoint or OneDrive.
- Outlook helps distribute and collaborate on content stored in Microsoft 365.

Teams, SharePoint, and OneDrive



Microsoft Teams

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SharePoint

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OneDrive

- Files shared in Teams channels are stored in SharePoint.
- Files shared in Teams chats are stored in OneDrive.
- Team members can collaborate on shared documents directly from Teams.
- Changes made to files are available to all authorized users in real time.
- Teams provides a single interface to access content stored in SharePoint and OneDrive.
- File permissions are managed through the underlying SharePoint and OneDrive storage.

How Copilot integrates with the ecosystem



Microsoft 365 Copilot

- Copilot works across the content and conversations the user is already allowed to open.
- In Outlook it summarises email threads and drafts replies from mailbox content.
- In Teams it summarises meetings and chat conversations.
- In SharePoint and OneDrive it reasons over documents the user can access.
- Group membership and site permissions define what Copilot can use.
- Copilot adds an intelligence layer; it does not create new copies of the content.

Integration matrix

One label per pair, listed once - no pair is repeated in both directions

	Outlook	Teams	SharePoint	OneDrive	Group calendar
Microsoft 365 Groups	Group email and group calendar	Shared membership	Connected team site	No direct relationship	Shared group calendar
Outlook		Meetings and communication	Document links	Cloud attachments	Group calendar in Outlook
Teams			Channel file storage	Chat file storage	Teams meeting link on events
SharePoint				Shared storage technology	No direct relationship

How to read it Shaded cells are the mirrored half of the matrix: each unique pair, including the group calendar, is described once in the upper half.

Key rules to remember

The statements that resolve most Microsoft 365 collaboration confusion

STRUCTURE

- Every standard Team has a Microsoft 365 Group
- Every standard Team has one or more connected SharePoint sites
- Every Microsoft 365 Group has a connected SharePoint team site
- Not every Microsoft 365 Group has a Team
- Not every SharePoint site has a Microsoft 365 Group

STORAGE

- OneDrive is primarily for personal files
- SharePoint is primarily for shared organisational files
- Teams chat files and Teams channel files use different storage models
- Group email and channel email are different

CALENDARS AND COPILOT

- Group calendar and personal calendar are different
- Enabling a Teams meeting does not automatically invite all Group members
- Copilot uses only information the user is authorised to access
- Other Microsoft 365 products extend the collaboration ecosystem

Use this as a test If a statement contradicts one of these rules, check where the content is actually stored and which membership grants the access.

The mental model

Copilot - authorised context across the ecosystem

Outlook

Email and calendar, including the group calendar

Microsoft Teams

Channels, posts, chats, meetings; every standard team has a group

SharePoint

Shared organisational content; a team site for every group

Microsoft 365 Groups

Organise shared membership and connected resources

OneDrive

Personal working files, individual ownership, built on SharePoint technology

Planner · Forms · OneNote · Loop · Stream · Viva Engage - extend the collaboration experience

Groups organise membership · the applications provide the experiences · SharePoint and OneDrive hold the content · Copilot works within existing permissions

Mandatory links: every group has a SharePoint team site and every standard team has a group - Teams and the extended services are optional additions.